THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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CLASS X — ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184) · PRACTICE PAPER · SET 03

Session 2026-27 · Mid-Term Pattern

Class: X	Subject: English Language and Literature	Time: 3 Hours	Max. Marks: 80

General Instructions:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections — Section A: Reading Skills; Section B: Grammar and Writing Skills; Section C: Literature Textbook.
3. Attempt questions based on the specific instructions given for each part.

SECTION A — READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

1. Every June, millions of Indian farmers look towards the southwest with the same question: will the monsoon arrive on time? The monsoon, a seasonal wind system that brings heavy rain from June to September, provides nearly seventy per cent of India's annual rainfall. Although the country has built dams and canals, a large part of its farmland still depends directly on these rains, which makes the monsoon the real finance minister of the nation.

2. The effect of the monsoon on crops is easy to see. Rice, cotton, pulses and sugarcane are sown at the start of the rains and harvested in the autumn. A timely and well-spread monsoon gives farmers healthy crops, while a delayed or weak one forces them to sow again, or even leave their fields empty. A heavy burst of rain in a short time can be equally harmful, since it washes away seeds and floods standing crops.

3. The influence of the rains does not end in the fields. When harvests are good, farmers have money to spend, and markets for tractors, clothes and household goods become busy. Food prices remain stable and the government spends less on importing grain. When the monsoon fails, rural incomes fall, prices of vegetables and pulses rise, and many families are pushed into debt. For this reason, the monthly rainfall reports are followed as closely by economists as by farmers. Even the price of a plate of dal in a distant city quietly depends on whether the clouds opened over a village in time.

4. Scientists have lately improved the forecasting of rainfall with the help of satellites, weather radars and computer models. Farmers receive advice on mobile phones about the best time to sow and when to expect heavy showers. Even so, climate change has made the monsoon less predictable, with long dry spells followed by sudden downpours, and forecasts alone cannot protect fields from such swings.

5. Farmers and planners are therefore turning to measures that reduce the risk. Drip irrigation saves water, drought-resistant seeds withstand weak rains, and village ponds store extra water for dry weeks. Crop insurance gives some security when the rains fail. These steps will not change the weather, but they can ensure that a poor monsoon does not turn into a disaster for the family that depends on the land. Above all, they remind us that a country which feeds a billion people must learn to live wisely with uncertain rain, sharing water and knowledge as carefully as it shares its harvest.

Created for academic usage / 416 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why is the monsoon described as 'the real finance minister of the nation'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

II. According to Paragraph 2, a heavy burst of rain in a short time harms crops EXCEPT by **1**

(A) washing away seeds
(B) flooding standing crops
(C) forcing farmers to sow again
(D) helping seeds to sprout evenly

III. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from the brackets: A delayed monsoon increases the _____ of farmers. (profits / risk) (Paragraph 2) **1**

IV. Select the option that is TRUE according to Paragraph 3. **1**

(A) Food prices rise when harvests are good.
(B) When harvests are good, markets become busy.
(C) Only farmers follow rainfall reports.
(D) The government imports more grain after good harvests.

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Satellite : Weather forecast :: Drip irrigation : _____

(A) Saving water
(B) Flooding fields

VI. Why can forecasts alone not protect farmers in the age of climate change? (Paragraph 4) **2**

VII. What are the main ideas of Paragraph 3 and Paragraph 5? **1**

i. Rainfall affects the whole economy, not only farms.
ii. Farmers can reduce the risk of poor rains by adopting new measures.
iii. The government should stop importing grain.
iv. The monsoon is always harmful.
v. Mobile phones are costly.

Option	Main idea of Paragraph 3	Main idea of Paragraph 5
A	iii	iv
B	ii	i
C	i	ii
D	iv	v

VIII. What can be inferred about the measures listed in Paragraph 5? Why does the author say they 'will not change the weather'? (Paragraph 5) **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

1. A survey of 400 students in Classes 8 to 10 examined how much time they spend on screens outside school hours. The findings were striking. Nearly 70% of the students (280) reported using screens for more than three hours a day, while the remaining 30% (120) used them for less. Of those who spend more than three hours, 60% (168) said they watch videos, 25% (70) play games, and the rest use screens mainly for study.

2. The effect on daily life was also studied. Among the 280 heavy users, 49% (about 137) said that they often slept late, compared with only 12 of the 120 lighter users (10%). Similarly, 35% of all the students (140) admitted that they had less time for outdoor play than a year earlier. Teachers noted that students who spent less time on screens were generally more attentive in morning classes. Many students also confessed that they felt restless and bored when they were away from their phones for even an hour, a sign that the habit had grown stronger than they realised.

3. Experts do not suggest banning technology, since many students use it for learning. Instead they advise fixed screen-free hours, family meals without phones and at least an hour of outdoor activity every day. With a little discipline, screens can serve as a tool rather than a habit that controls the day. Parents, too, must set an example, because children copy what they see at home far more readily than what they are told.

Created for academic usage / 250 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why does the author call the survey's findings 'striking'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

II. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those in brackets. Of the heavy users, the largest group mainly use screens to _____. (study / watch videos) (Paragraph 1) **1**

III. Select the option that is TRUE according to Paragraph 2. **1**

(A) More lighter users slept late than heavy users.
(B) Lighter users slept late less often than heavy users.
(C) Heavy users were more attentive in class.
(D) Outdoor play has increased.

IV. Which of the following is the best meaning of 'attentive' in Paragraph 2? **1**

(A) Sleepy
(B) Paying close attention
(C) Noisy
(D) Absent

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Fixed screen-free hours : Discipline :: Outdoor activity : _____

(A) Physical fitness
(B) Screen addiction

VI. Complete the following appropriately. About 168 of the heavy users watch videos, which is ____ % of the 280. (Paragraph 1) **1**

VII. What do the data in Paragraph 2 suggest about the link between screen time and sleep? **1**

VIII. What do experts advise instead of banning technology? Give any two suggestions. (Paragraph 3) **1**

IX. How can screens become 'a tool rather than a habit'? Explain in your own words. (Paragraph 3) **2**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR AND WRITING SKILLS — 20 marks

GRAMMAR — 10

3. Complete any ten of the twelve of the following tasks, as directed. **(10 × 1 = 10)**

I. Fill in the blank using the correct form of the word in brackets for a school notice: **1**
Students are requested to maintain _____ (disciplined) during the assembly.

II. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**
She is senior than me by two years.

ERROR	CORRECTION

III. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. **1**
By the time the guests arrived, the cook _____ (prepare) the entire meal.

IV. Read the given statement. **1**
The coach said to the team, “We will practise at six tomorrow.”
Report it by completing: The coach told the team that _____.

V. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **1**
The manager was angry _____ the clerk for the delay.

(A) of
(B) with
(C) to
(D) on

VI. Report the following. **1**
“Please help me carry these bags,” the old woman said to the boy.
The old woman requested _____.

VII. Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option. **1**
He is looking forward _____ his friends at the reunion.

(A) to meet
(B) to meeting
(C) meeting
(D) to have met

VIII. The sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies it. **1**
Neither of the answers are correct.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Neither	None
B.	are	is
C.	answers	answer
D.	correct	corrects

IX. Report the following question. **1**
"Where did you buy this jacket?" my friend asked me.

X. Choose the correct option from the brackets. **1**
You _____ (should / used to) inform your parents before going out; it is a matter of courtesy.

XI. Fill in the blank with the correct option. **1**
She has _____ patience than her sister.
(A) much
(B) more
(C) most
(D) many

XII. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**
The furniture in the rooms were old.

ERROR	CORRECTION

4. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. You are Rohan/Rhea, a resident of Green Park Colony. The street lights in your lane have not worked for two weeks, causing safety problems at night. Write a letter to the Executive Engineer of the Electricity Department, in about 120 words, requesting immediate repair.

OR

B. You are Kavya/Kabir. Your school has no facility for rainwater harvesting despite frequent water shortage. Write a letter to the Principal, in about 120 words, proposing a rainwater harvesting system and explaining its advantages.

5. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. Two students are being considered for the post of School Sports Captain. **Dev:** an outstanding footballer who wins matches single-handedly, but he rarely listens to teammates and often argues with referees. **Tara:** an average player, but she encourages juniors, plans practice sessions and resolves disputes calmly. Analyse the profiles and decide who should be Sports Captain. (100–120 words)

OR

B. The table compares two ways of travelling from Jaipur to Delhi.

Features	Bus	Train
Fare	₹550	₹320
Journey time	5.5 hours	4.5 hours
Departures per day	40	6
Luggage space	Limited	Ample
Comfort	Reclining seats	Berth/chair car

Study the data and write an analytical paragraph in 100–120 words comparing them and recommending the better option for a family with heavy luggage.

SECTION C — LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

> *The writer says that the hills of Coorg are covered with coffee estates and spice plants, and that clouds sit low among the trees. The people there, the Kodavus, are proud of their traditions and warm towards guests. Many families have sent their sons to serve in the army, and the region is known for producing brave soldiers.*
>
> (Glimpses of India (Coorg) — extract adapted)

I. What is Coorg famous for? **1**

(A) Textile mills
(B) Coffee estates and spices
(C) Deserts
(D) Ports

II. What is said about the Kodavus' attitude towards guests? **1**

III. Complete suitably. Many Kodavu families send their sons to the _____. **1**

(A) police
(B) army
(C) railways
(D) courts

IV. Which two qualities of the people of Coorg does the extract highlight? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

OR

(b)

> *The little otter was kept in a small box on the journey. He cried and clung to the writer at first, but soon began to play in the bath and splash about with such joy that the water covered the whole floor. From then on the writer knew that he would have to look after an animal who treated every day as a game.*
>
> (Mijbil the Otter — extract adapted)

I. Where was the otter kept during the journey? **1**

(A) In a cage
(B) In a small box
(C) In a car
(D) In a bag

II. What shows that Mijbil was playful? **1**

III. Complete suitably. The writer realised that the otter treated every day as a _____. **1**

(A) fight
(B) game
(C) task
(D) burden

IV. How does the extract show the writer's growing bond with Mijbil? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

> *The poet says that to recognise wild animals one need not be afraid. A tiger is known by the pattern of its fur and by the way it glides. If one gets close enough to meet it, there will be little time to wonder about its looks, because by then it will be too late.*
>
> (How to Tell Wild Animals — paraphrased)

I. How does the poem advise recognising a tiger? **1**

(A) By its colour
(B) By its fur pattern and walk
(C) By its size
(D) By its cry

II. What is the poet's tone in these lines? **1**

(A) Serious
(B) Humorous
(C) Angry
(D) Grieving

III. The warning that 'it will be too late' is meant to be _____. **1**

(A) tragic
(B) funny and ironic
(C) factual
(D) instructive

IV. How does the poet create humour in the poem? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

OR

(b)

> *A young man replies to an elderly lady that people do not love him for his golden hair alone. He says that his hair may be admired, but only God can love him for himself, and he does not want to be loved only for what he looks like.*
>
> (For Anne Gregory — paraphrased)

I. What does the young man say about his hair? **1**

(A) Love for his hair is false
(B) It is admired but not loved for itself
(C) It is dyed
(D) It is the only thing he has

II. Who can love him for himself, according to the poem? **1**

(A) Nobody
(B) Only God
(C) His mother
(D) The lady

III. The poem criticises the idea that love depends on _____. **1**

(A) wealth
(B) outward appearance
(C) honesty
(D) age

IV. What message does the poem convey about real love? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions in 40–50 words each. (4 × 3 = 12)

I. How did Anne Frank's relationship with Peter change over time? (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

II. Why did Valli's imagination make her ride the bus? What did the ride teach her? (Madam Rides the Bus)

III. How does Matilda's loss of the necklace affect her life? (The Necklace)

IV. What changes take place in Bholi when she goes to school? (Bholi)

V. Why did Lencho write a letter to God? (A Letter to God)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions in 40–50 words each. (2 × 3 = 6)

I. How does the thief trick Hari Singh in 'The Thief's Story'? (The Thief's Story)

II. How does Mandela show that freedom must be for all? (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

III. How did Griffin's invisibility turn him into a danger to society? (Footprints Without Feet)

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) Discuss how 'The Ball Poem' and 'A Letter to God' present loss and how the characters respond to it. (The Ball Poem / A Letter to God)

O R

(B) Compare the ways in which 'Fire and Ice' and 'Amanda!' deal with strong feelings and the need for control. (Fire and Ice / Amanda!)

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) 'Bholi' is a story of transformation. Discuss how education changes Bholi's life. (Bholi)

O R

(B) Discuss how Nelson Mandela's address highlights the cost of freedom and the need for courage. (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)